



b. 1976 · British-American computer scientist; co-founder of Google Brain and Coursera.

"It's not the model, it's the data and the plumbing."

THE WHY THAT DROVE THE WORK

Ng argues that, for most organisations, the bottleneck to AI value is not the model but the data and the engineering around it.

INTELLECTUAL FOUNDATION

A leading machine-learning researcher and educator, he led large-scale AI efforts at Google and Baidu and championed the shift from model-centric to data-centric AI.

FRAMEWORKS ANCHORED IN THIS COURSE

He anchors the MLOps Maturity Ladder in Unit 3's model-and-talent Slibrary and informs its treatment of operational cost.

HOW THE IDEAS OPERATIONALISE

His view operationalises as investing in data quality, reliable pipelines and disciplined MLOps rather than chasing marginal model gains.

LIMITATIONS & CRITIQUE

The data-centric emphasis can understate cases where model architecture genuinely matters, and 'good data' is itself hard to define and obtain.

ENDURING IMPACT

Ng has shaped both AI research and its practical adoption, and through online education brought machine learning to millions.

ON THE SAME PANEL (UNIT 3)

Nassim Nicholas Taleb · Giant 11

Cathy O'Neil · Giant 12

Roy Schwartz et al. · Giant 14

J.B. Quinn · Giant 15

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Ng, A. (2021) 'A chat with Andrew on MLOps: From model-centric to data-centric AI', DeepLearning.AI.

Kreuzberger, D., Kühl, N. and Hirschl, S. (2023) 'Machine learning operations (MLOps)', IEEE Access, 11.